



Digital Literacy Awareness Project (CSE0001)

PROJECT REPORT

Name: Rishav Raj

Registration Number: 25BCE11039

Branch: B.Tech CSE (Core)

Year: First Year

Course Code: CSE0001

Date of submission: 31st, March 2026

Introduction

The Digital Literacy Awareness Project (CSE0001) is more than a technical requirement; it serves as a practical roadmap for navigating the complexities of our professional and academic lives. In an era where being "online" is a constant state of being, simply knowing how to operate a device is no longer enough. This project was designed to bridge the gap between basic usage and intentional, ethical, and safe digital engagement.

Acting as a Student Digital Ambassador, I completed five hands-on tasks that mirrored real-world challenges. Throughout this journey, I explored the art of visual communication, curated a professional digital footprint, and refined my technical skill set. I also delved into the nuances of professional email etiquette and analysed the sobering reality of modern cyber threats. Ultimately, this process was about more than just completing assignments; it was about building a secure, impactful online presence and learning to wield digital tools with a sense of responsibility and purpose.

Task 1:

What I made: I created a one-page educational infographic titled "A Student's Guide to Digital Literacy" to visually communicate core concepts to my peers. The infographic is divided into three distinct sections: defining digital literacy, outlining "Safe Internet Practices" (like using a password manager, 2FA, and avoiding public Wi-Fi for sensitive accounts), and maintaining a "Professional Online Presence." I specifically highlighted the importance of a "Code & Connect" strategy, encouraging peers to host their Python and Java code on GitHub while keeping a clean LinkedIn profile for recruiters.

Tool used: I used Canva because of its intuitive drag-and-drop interface. It allowed me to use a striking, tech-themed digital tree background and clearly organized text boxes, so I could focus on making the educational content highly readable rather than getting bogged down in complex design software.

Reflection: Reflecting on this task, I realized how challenging it is to condense complex information into bite-sized, visually appealing pieces. It taught me that effective digital communication isn't just about what you say, but how accessible you make it for your audience. Creating this infographic reinforced my own understanding of digital safety and the professional footprint I am building as a CSE student.

Task 2:

Which platforms I chose: To establish a strong professional digital footprint as a CSE student, I chose to set up and optimize profiles on four major platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Kaggle.

What each one is used for: GitHub is used for version control and hosting code repositories; I use it to showcase my practical coding skills through hackathon projects like "MediConnect" and "Virasat-Setu." LinkedIn is a professional networking platform used to connect with industry peers and highlight my academic progress. HackerRank is a competitive coding platform where I practice and validate my Python and Java skills. Finally, Kaggle is a data science platform used for exploring datasets and machine learning models.

How I plan to use them over the next four years: Over my B.Tech journey, I plan to treat these platforms as a dynamic resume. Since my recent hackathons have ended, my immediate goal on GitHub is to refine my existing code and write detailed READMEs. Moving forward, I will continuously push new coursework and projects. I will use HackerRank to prepare for technical placements, Kaggle to build a data science portfolio, and LinkedIn to share these milestones, ultimately networking my way into summer internships.

Task 3

What platform(s) I used: To fulfill both the coding practice and cloud collaboration requirements, I utilized two distinct platforms. For coding practice, I chose HackerRank. For the cloud collaboration task, I utilized Google Workspace, specifically Google Forms and Google Sheets.

What I built or practised: On HackerRank, I actively practiced my programming logic by completing beginner-level challenges, which ultimately helped me earn my Python (Basic) certification. For the collaboration portion, I built a 5-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This quiz included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test my batchmates on safe internet practices. I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to automatically organize and view the collected responses.

How these tools will help me academically: As a CSE student, both of these tools are essential for my academic growth. HackerRank provides a structured environment to continuously improve my algorithmic thinking and prepare for future technical placements. Meanwhile, mastering Google Workspace will be incredibly valuable for coordinating group projects, collecting survey data for research assignments, and collaborating seamlessly with my peers throughout my B. Tech journey.

Task 4

Situation where poor communication caused a problem: A student reached out to a startup founder on LinkedIn for an internship but used "SMS language" and slang, like "Hey, u guys hiring? i code in py." The founder, looking for a professional intern to handle client data, immediately declined the request. The student had a great GitHub profile, but their initial poor digital communication created an impression that they were immature and not ready for a professional workplace environment.

What could have been done differently: The student could have secured the interview by maintaining a professional tone. They should have introduced themselves as a B.Tech student, briefly mentioned their specific projects and asked for a formal way to submit their resume. Following basic etiquette shows that a student respects the recipient's time and understands professional standards.

Task 5

What surprised you most: While researching the 2022 AIIMS Delhi Ransomware attack, I was most surprised by how a single digital vulnerability could completely cripple such a massive, critical institution. Seeing a premier national hospital forced back to manual, paper-based record-keeping for weeks was a stark reminder that cyber threats are not just about losing data or money; they can physically disrupt life-saving services and endanger millions of patients. It was eye-opening to see that even with high-level security, the human element or an unpatched server remains a significant risk.

One habit you will personally change: As a result of this research, I have committed to the personal habit of never ignoring software update notifications on my devices. As a CSE student, it is easy to postpone updates to save time, but I now realize these patches are essential for closing security gaps. I will also strictly avoid downloading unverified software or "cracked" files, ensuring I maintain a secure and responsible digital environment for my academic and professional work.

Conclusion:

This project has been a real eye-opener for me as I start my B. Tech journey. Moving beyond just "using" apps, I have learned how to build a professional identity through platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn that will actually help me land internships later. Practicing professional emails and researching the AIIMS cyberattack taught me that being "tech-savvy" isn't enough; you have to be responsible and constantly alert. I now feel much more confident

navigating the digital space, not just as a student, but as a future engineer who understands the importance of security and professionalism.

References:

- Canva: <https://www.canva.com/> , for making the task 1 presentation
- HackerRank: <https://www.hackerrank.com/> , for task 3 certification and coding
- Google Forms: <https://forms.gle/Bu2HESfgeXrQUxvN7> , task 3 google form link
- CERT-In: [India Ransomware Report 2022]
https://www.csk.gov.in/documents/RANSOMWARE_Report_Final.pdf
- The Economic Times (2022): [AIIMS ransomware attack: what it means for health data privacy] <https://ciso.economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/aiims-ransomware-attack-what-it-means-for-health-data-privacy/96538957>